

Android OS by providing manufacturers the software platform around which they could build their hardware. And how's that coming along for them? Let's find out.

Inception

By the time Google had come out with the first version of Android Wear, wearables had been around for a while. While Fitbit had launched almost a decade ago, even the Pebble watch had just made a big splash and sold out within days of its launch. So what was Google waiting for? Getting the design right.

After the launch of the Moto 360, the first round faced Android Wear watch, Google revealed, in an exclusive to Verge, that they've been working on numerous different design ideas as well as user experiences in order to get the platform right in their first try. From a horizontal card stack to a compass layout, things could have been very different for Google's smartwatch OS had they settled differently with the final outcome. Eventually, they went ahead and released Android Wear 4.4W1.



The LG G Watch

Android Wear 4.4W1 – the original Android Wear 1

If you're confused by the version name, don't be. Google soon realised that tying the version number to the concurrent Android version of the time was not a great idea. From a consumer standpoint, it definitely conveyed an intention to keep the Android wear heavily dependent on a corresponding Android smartphone, which is a drawback for any wearable device.

To start off, Samsung Gear Live and LG G Watch were launched along with the platform. The LG G Watch was the first Android Wear smartwatch to be released and shipped. Motorola's Moto 360 was released on September 5, 2014.



Samsung Gear Live

Wear 4.4W1, and consequently 4.4W2 set the base for the Android powered smartwatch that was yet to come. But with features limited to things like music control over bluetooth and